

other folder you choose to. An application is not a folder full of myriad sorts of files—it is just a single file with the “APP” extension, self-contained and independent of any other files. So you don’t need to install it, you can just move it around on the system and to uninstall it, you just delete it. It is that simple. It might take some days for a switcher to get used to the simplicity.

### 5.3.6 Working With Files

Another major addition to Tiger was Spotlight, the revolutionary search utility that is deeply integrated with the operating system at the core level, and indexes every file on the system to facilitate instantaneous and accurate system-wide searching. It always keeps running in the background and tracks changes as and when you make them, keeping the index constantly updated. However, it uses very little of the system resources and does the job as it is expected to, flawlessly. Hit the shortcut ([**Cmd**] + [**Spacebar**]) and the little blue search bar pops up at the top right corner of the system, with the search field active. As you enter in your query, Spotlight displays results as you type, narrowing down results with each new character. Almost always, the file you are searching for is at the top of the list, ready to be launched. If not the top hit, it most likely is present in the list of the other files. Just scroll down to the one you want and hit Return (or [**Cmd**] + [**Return**] to reveal the folder the file is in).

Clicking on “Show All” takes you to a neatly-designed window that lists all the files it found for your search query, and allows you to view several details for these files, group them based on kind, date, and people, or just show a flat list, or filter them out based on criteria such as time and location.



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